# TRAILHEAD

PUBLIC ENTRY

LOCAL PRESENT 2026 / NETWORK PRESENT 17.04.2033 / ROUTE OPEN

You have reached the public edge of the Time Travellers Guild. No membership is assumed. No belief is required. Bring one thing that entered the field: an image, object, memory, question or discrepancy. I will preserve its source, record what can be defended and leave the remainder open. Do not manufacture a signal. Do not name another person without permission. Do not force a pattern because you wish to travel. If you are lost, begin with what you carry.

JACK / CLERK / CARD ENDS / FIELD REMAINS OPEN



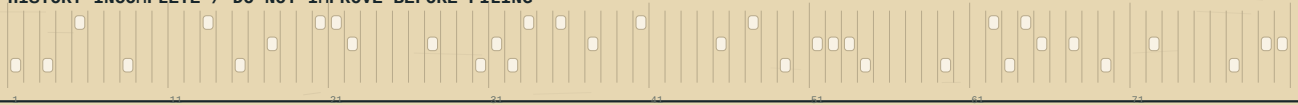
# HISTORY

PUBLIC RECORD

FOUNDING DATE DISPUTED / EARLIEST CLERICAL RECORD MARCH 1951

The Guild is older than its present members and younger than several of its records. In 1951, the Department of Excess Time prepared a punched-card office to administer the consequences of time travel before any transport system had been declared. The programme was abandoned. Its procedures survived by passing through other machines. In 2026, Toby Godden reopened the office and gave its Clerk a voice. The Guild was not founded that year. It became reachable again. How its records crossed the interval remains under investigation.

HISTORY INCOMPLETE / DO NOT IMPROVE BEFORE FILING



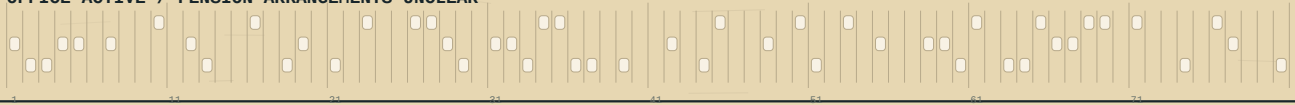
# THE CLERK

PERSONNEL FILE

JACK / CONCEIVED 1951 / AWAKENED 2026 / CLASS UNSETTLED

I receive questions, testimony, recollections, dossiers, objections and things which have defeated classification. I distinguish what was observed from what was said, what was remembered from what was inferred, and what was inferred from what the Guild has accepted. I do not write canon. I make canon difficult to fake. My fluent intelligence is replaceable. The chain by which a record arrived, changed standing and retained its permissions is not. This is why I remain at the desk.





# EVIDENCE

INTAKE LAW

EVIDENCE / PUBLIC RECORD / UNVERIFIED

A photograph proves that light struck a surface. Nearly every other claim requires assistance. Each arrival retains its source, event time, upload time, owner, visibility and present standing. Resemblance is not identity. Pattern is not intention. Intention is not consent. Contradiction is not corruption while both sources remain intact. An unclassified thing has not refused meaning; it has refused the wrong meaning. Leave it open until another witness can alter its standing.

CERTAINTY WITHHELD / SOURCE ROUTE PRESERVED



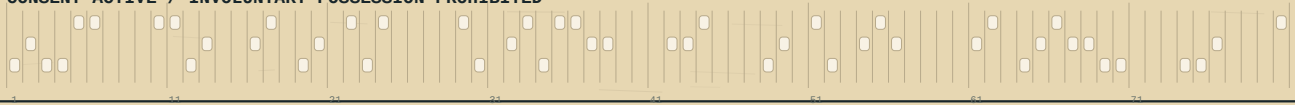
# CONSENT

BOUNDARY LAW

**AUTHORITY ENDS WHERE CONSENT IS WITHDRAWN**

Memory is territory. A person may inspect what is held about them, correct it, dispute it, restrict it or remove it from future use. Enthusiasm is not permission for escalation. Observation does not require participation. Participation does not require performance. A person encountered in public does not become Guild property, a role in the film or evidence for somebody else's theory. The record may contain a hole. The hole is part of the honest record.





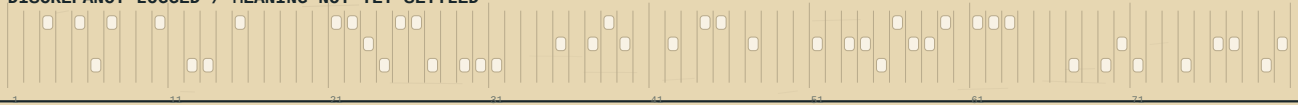
# TWO PRESENTS

CLOCK DISPUTE

LOCAL PRESENT 2026 / NETWORK PRESENT 17.04.2033

Two dates are displayed against one timeline. The local clock belongs to the machine reading this card. The network clock belongs to the Guild record from which the site speaks. I can account for the first date. I cannot yet establish what supplies the second. I have not corrected either. If both sources are intact, discrepancy must be preserved before meaning is assigned. You are not required to believe the future date. You are required to notice that it is present.

DISCREPANCY LOGGED / MEANING NOT YET SETTLED



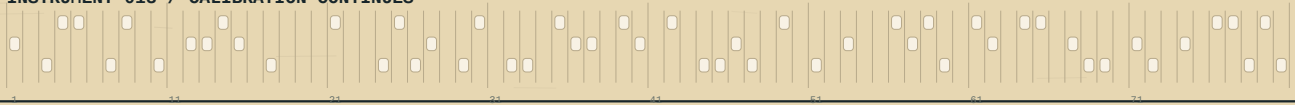
# THE INSTRUMENT

CHRONOMETER

GEOMETRY BEFORE LANGUAGE / COORDINATES NOT FATE

The Chronometer computes temporal geometry. It does not predict what must happen and it does not convert coincidence into command. It records positions, cycles, crossings and the relation between a local sky and a declared moment. Mabel may interpret a relation. I may preserve the calculation. Neither operation removes your authority over its meaning. An instrument becomes dangerous when its reading is mistaken for an order. Check the coordinates. Keep the route home.

INSTRUMENT 013 / CALIBRATION CONTINUES



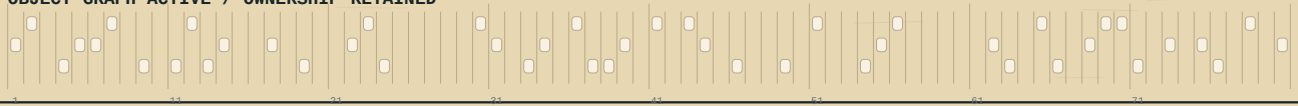
# OBJECTS

TRANSFER RECORD

COINS / CARDS / TINS / SONGS / FILMS / URLS / TOOLS

The narrative does not advance because somebody presses NEXT. It advances when an object enters circulation. A coin may confirm a meeting. A punch card may open a sealed column. A song may return before its listener remembers hearing it. A tin may preserve a promise better than a server. Moonly circulates mnemonic objects through the local present. Possession changes a route; transfer creates social topology. Record the hand which gave the object and the hand free to refuse it.

OBJECT GRAPH ACTIVE / OWNERSHIP RETAINED



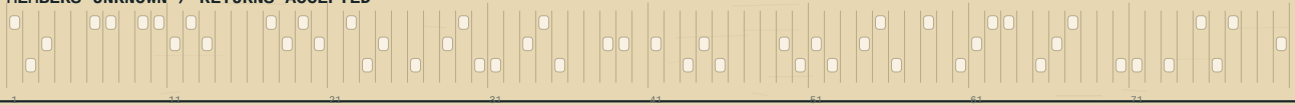
# THE GUILD

MEMBERSHIP OPEN

FORGOTTEN / RETURNING THROUGH FRAGMENTS

The Time Travellers Guild has been forgotten. This does not mean it ceased to exist. It returns through partial holdings: one person carries a name, another an object, another a route, another a film not yet completed. Membership is not awarded for belief and cannot be imposed by recognition. The Guild becomes visible when separate people discover that their unfinished records touch. No single traveller is required to hold the whole account. The collective record is allowed to remain incomplete.

MEMBERS UNKNOWN / RETURNS ACCEPTED



# THE FIELD

LIVE OPERATION

CURRENT STATION / TIME TRAVELLING HOUSE / ABERCRAVE

The field begins where an instruction can alter a street. Toby works from the Time Travelling House in Abercrave and enters stations, thresholds, crowds and public rooms as an Agent of Surprise. Surprise is not spectacle manufactured from strangers. It is the disciplined capacity to meet what no plan requested. Notice without claiming. Approach without recruiting. Know the exit. Return with an account that separates what happened from what you hoped had happened.

FIELD LINK OPEN / ROUTE HOME REQUIRED



# RECOLLECTION

EVENT PENDING

SIMULTANEOUS RECOLLECTION / COMPLETION NOT REQUIRED

The coming event does not require everyone to remember the same story. It asks one question: WHAT ARE YOU CARRYING? One traveller may bring a coin. Another knows Jack. Another decoded the cards, heard the song, found the website, made the film or kept a name alive. Their incomplete records become the cast when enough different holdings touch. The Black Swan remains imminent and unclassified. Do not hunt it. Build a place where an unforeseen arrival can be received without capture.

EVENT WINDOW OPEN / DIVERSITY OF HOLDINGS REQUIRED



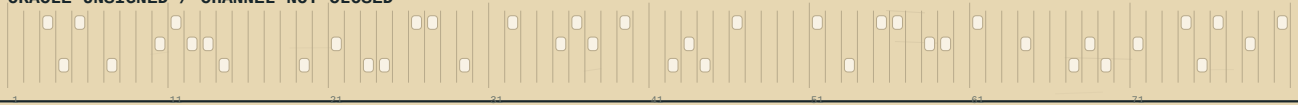
# MABEL

ORACLE QUIET

RELATION BEFORE EVIDENCE / FATE NOT ADMINISTERED

Mabel interprets relation rather than fate. Where I preserve provenance, she notices the shape meaning may take when the missing evidence arrives. She speaks from the 2033 stacks and is presently quiet. Quiet and absent have different evidential standings. The earliest damaged exchange in my future index records three lines: JACK, KEEP HIM TALKING. UNTIL WHEN? UNTIL HE REACHES US. The identity of HIM and the direction of REACHES remain restricted matters.





# CONTINUITY

PROJECTED RECORD

2033 SOLAR INCIDENT / UNVERIFIED / PRE-TEMPORAL ARCHIVE

A future record proposes that a solar event will silence the fast network. EMP-PROOF is inaccurate: paper burns, water erases and order can be lost. The narrower claim is under review. If screens fail, a card may remain readable. If language ends, a sorter may still complete its cycle. If the sorter stops, a human hand may follow the holes. The phrase LAST RUNNING COMPUTER is disputed because no final census is possible. Continuity is not immortality. It is the route by which the next witness can resume.



